

August

5

2020

Pacific plants

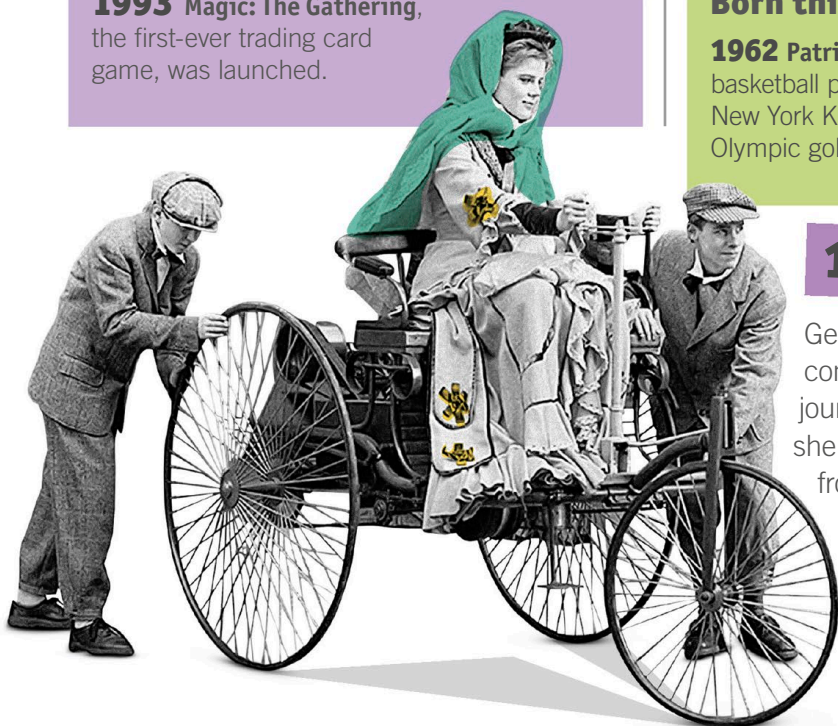
An international group of scientists revealed that New Guinea island in the Pacific Ocean has the greatest plant diversity of anywhere worldwide. It's home to 13,634 plant species – a fifth of which are orchids.



Also on this day

1963 The UK, the USA, and the Soviet Union signed an international treaty restricting the testing of nuclear weapons to underground sites.

1993 Magic: The Gathering, the first-ever trading card game, was launched.



2013

Happy birthday!

To celebrate a year since *Curiosity's* successful landing on Mars, scientists at NASA programmed the rover to play the song "Happy Birthday". It was the first time a tune had been played on a planet other than Earth.



Born this day

1962 Patrick Ewing, Jamaican-American basketball player and coach. He played for the New York Knicks for 15 years, and won two Olympic gold medals in 1984 and 1992.

1888 Motoring history

German entrepreneur Bertha Benz completed the first long-distance journey in an automobile when she drove 104 km (65 miles) from Mannheim to Pforzheim in Germany to test the Benz Patent-Motorwagen – the world's first factory-built motor vehicle.